



Arthur Scargill, leader of the National Union of Miners (NUM), confronts a battalion of police during the British miners' strike, which lasted a year.



BRITISH COAL MINERS WENT ON STRIKE from March 12 over pay and mine closures. The dispute lasted an entire year.

Police constable Yvonne Fletcher was killed outside the **Libyan Embassy** in London during a demonstration on April 17. Her death led to a **police siege** of the building. Subsequently, the UK expelled Libyan diplomats from the country.

On December 19, **China** and **Britain** signed a treaty to transfer **Hong Kong**, a British colony, to Chinese rule in 1997.

An **IRA bomb** went off at the Grand Hotel, **Brighton**, on

55,000

15,000

3,000

have died since
died within weeks

Bhopal gas victims

The Bhopal tragedy injured many thousands and killed 3,000 people within weeks. At least 15,000 are thought to have died subsequently.

Free in space

US astronaut Bruce McCandless floats free in space. He used a jet pack to fly nearly 300 feet (91 m) away from the shuttle Challenger.



Two billion viewers in 60 countries watched the Live Aid concerts.

TANCREDO NEVES (1910–85) WAS ELECTED PRESIDENT OF BRAZIL

on 15 January, after 21 years of military rule. Democracy also returned to **Uruguay**, in March, and to **Bolivia**, in August.

On 25 May, hundreds died in attacks on Palestinian strongholds in **Beirut** by Syrian-backed **Shi'ite** troops. Prime minister **Shimon Peres** (b.1923) withdrew Israeli troops from Lebanon, but Israel held a 12 mile- (19 km-) wide **security zone** in the south.

Later in the year, on October 7, Palestinian Liberation Organization (PLO) militants hijacked an Italian cruise liner, the *Achille Lauro*, demanding the release of **50 Palestinian prisoners** held in Israel. The crisis ended after they

Red ribbon

A symbol of solidarity for those suffering from HIV/AIDS, the Red Ribbon Foundation was formed in 1993 to promote awareness about the disease.



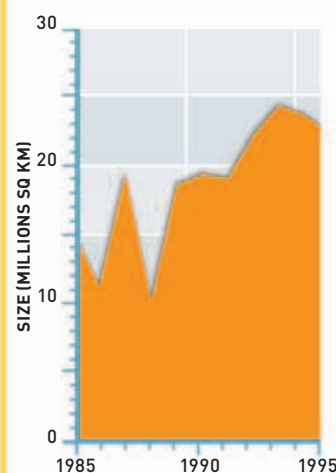
October 12, targeting the British cabinet who had gathered for the **Conservative Party conference**. Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher (b. 1925) had a narrow escape.

Major General Mohammed Buhari (b. 1942) seized power in Nigeria in a bloodless **military coup** on January 1, citing the government's corruption record.

Indira Gandhi (b. 1917), the prime minister of India, was **assassinated** on October 31. The killing was carried out by **Sikh extremists** in response to an attack on the Sikh shrine, the **Golden Temple of Amritsar**. Gandhi ordered the attack, known as **Operation Blue Star**, to remove Sikh separatists, who were thought to be amassing weapons at the temple. The operation resulted in up to **1,000 deaths**.

On December 3, a **poison-gas leak** at the US-owned Union Carbide pesticide plant near **Bhopal**, India, became one of the worst industrial accidents in history.

The US president **Ronald Reagan** (1911–2004) declared the withdrawal of peacekeeping troops from the Lebanese capital of **Beirut**, on February 7, following increased terrorist attacks.



Hole in the ozone layer

This graph shows the average size of the hole in the ozone layer in each year from 1985–95. As a comparison, the area of Europe is about 4 million sq miles (10 million sq km).

